Scoping Review Protocol

Pre-service Teachers' Professional Development for Cultural and Linguistic Diversity through Teaching Internships Abroad: A Systematic Scoping Review

Denis Weger, Language Teaching and Learning Research Unit, Centre for Teacher Education, University of Vienna

1. Background and Rationale

Context: The professional development of pre-service teachers is crucial for addressing the challenges of linguistically and culturally diverse classrooms. Teaching internships abroad have been proposed as valuable experiences for fostering this development, yet the scope of research on their impact remains unclear.

Purpose: This scoping review aims to map existing literature on the influence of teaching internships abroad on the professionalization of pre-service teachers for teaching in linguistically and culturally diverse classrooms to identify research gaps and inform future studies.

2. Objectives

- Identify key themes in the literature regarding the professional development of pre-service teachers through international teaching experiences.
- Examine how such experiences shape beliefs, attitudes, and instructional approaches toward linguistic and cultural diversity.
- Highlight gaps in research and suggest future directions for empirical studies.

3. Research Questions

1) What are the characteristics, study designs, and theoretical frameworks of research on pre-service teachers' professionalization for teaching in culturally and linguistically diverse classrooms during teaching internships abroad?
2) What are the reported outcomes of teaching internships abroad on the professionalization of pre-service teachers for teaching in culturally und linguistically diverse classrooms?

4. Methodology

4.1. Framework and inclusion/exclusion criteria

Criterion	Inclusion	Exclusion
Population	Pre-service teachers (student teachers, teacher candidates)	In-service teachers, other education professionals
Intervention/Experience	Teaching internship/practicum abroad; teaching in primary or secondary schools	Study abroad without teaching component, teaching in elementary settings, adult education or out of school-activities
Outcome	Professionalization related to teaching in linguistic and/or cultural diversity (attitudes, beliefs, instructional practices, competencies)	General teacher professionalization without focus on linguistic and/or cultural diversity; studies examining linguistic or cultural developments of pre-service teachers without relating them to teaching in linguistically and/or culturally diverse settings
Study Design	Empirical studies (qualitative, quantitative, mixed-methods), pre-service teachers as data source	Opinion pieces, reviews, theoretical papers without empirical data, data sources other than pre-service teachers (e.g. school administrators, teacher educators, …)
Time Frame	Studies from 2000 to 2024	Studies older than 2000
Language	English, German	Other languages unless an accessible translation exists

4.2. Search Strategy

- Databases: ERIC (1.470), Web of Science (82), Scopus (110), Education Research Complete (EBSCOhost), German Database: (FIS Bildung 31),

- Keywords:

PCC	Description	Search Terms
Population	Pre-service teachers	("pre-service teacher*" OR "student teacher*" OR "teacher trainee*" OR "teacher candidate*" OR "future teacher*" OR "prospective teacher*" OR "teacher education student*"
Concept	Teaching Abroad (TA), Auslandspraktikum, Sprachassistenzprogramme	"teaching abroad" OR "international teaching internship" OR "international teaching practice" OR "international mobility" OR "international teaching experience" OR "foreign language teaching assistant*" OR "teaching assistant*" OR "international field experience" OR "study abroad" OR "Erasmus+ teaching mobility" OR "international student teaching" OR "teaching assistant program*" OR "cross-cultural teaching experience" OR "global teacher education" OR "international practicum" OR "teacher mobility")
Context	Professionalisierung	("profession* " OR "competen*" OR " learning" OR "identit*" OR " development" OR "growth")

4.3. Search Strings and results

Search String for Scopus Advanced Search

TITLE-ABS-KEY(("pre-service teacher*" OR "student teacher*" OR "teacher trainee*" OR "teacher candidate*" OR "future teacher*" OR "prospective teacher*" OR "teacher education student*") AND ("teaching abroad" OR "international teaching internship" OR "international teaching practice" OR "international mobility" OR "international teaching experience" OR "foreign language teaching assistant*" OR "teaching assistant*" OR "international field experience" OR "study abroad" OR "Erasmus+ teaching mobility" OR "international student teaching" OR "teaching assistant program*" OR "cross-cultural teaching experience" OR

"global teacher education" OR "international practicum" OR "teacher mobility") AND ("profession* " OR "competen*" OR " learning" OR "identit*" OR " development" OR "growth"))AND (LANGUAGE(english) OR LANGUAGE(german) OR LANGUAGE(italian))AND PUBYEAR > 1999

---> **RESULT:** 379 studies (05.02.2025)

Search String für Edvanced Search in der Education Collection (ProQuest)

TI,AB,SU(("pre-service teacher*" OR "student teacher*" OR "teacher trainee*" OR "teacher candidate*" OR "future teacher*" OR "prospective teacher*" OR "teacher education student*") AND ("teaching abroad" OR "international teaching internship" OR "international teaching practice" OR "international mobility" OR "international teaching experience" OR "foreign language teaching assistant*" OR "teaching assistant*" OR "international field experience" OR "study abroad" OR "Erasmus+ teaching mobility" OR "international student teaching" OR "teaching assistant program*" OR "cross-cultural teaching experience" OR "global teacher education" OR "international practicum" OR "teacher mobility") AND ("profession*" OR "competen*" OR "learning" OR "identit*" OR "development" OR "growth")) AND (LA(English) OR LA(German) OR LA(Italian)) AND PY(>1999))

---> **RESULT:** 373 studies (05.02.2025)

Search String for Advanced Search in Web of Science

TS=("pre-service teacher*" OR "student teacher*" OR "teacher trainee*" OR "teacher candidate*" OR "future teacher*" OR "prospective teacher*" OR "teacher education student*")

AND

TS=("teaching abroad" OR "international teaching internship" OR "international teaching practice" OR "international mobility" OR "international teaching experience" OR "foreign language teaching assistant*" OR "teaching assistant*" OR "international field experience" OR "study abroad" OR "Erasmus+ teaching mobility" OR "international student teaching" OR "teaching assistant program*" OR "cross-cultural teaching experience" OR "global teacher education" OR "international practicum" OR "teacher mobility")

AND

TS=("profession*" OR "competen*" OR "learning" OR "identit*" OR "development" OR "growth")

AND

LA=("English" OR "German" OR "Italian")

AND

PY=(2000-2025)

---> **RESULT:** 164 studies (05.02.2025)

Education Research Complete (EBSCOhost)

("pre-service teacher*" OR "student teacher*" OR "teacher trainee*" OR "teacher candidate*" OR "future teacher*" OR "prospective teacher*" OR "teacher education student*") AND ("teaching abroad" OR "international teaching internship" OR "international teaching practice" OR "international mobility" OR "international teaching experience" OR "foreign language teaching assistant*" OR "teaching assistant*" OR "international field experience" OR "study abroad" OR "Erasmus+ teaching mobility" OR "international student teaching" OR "teaching assistant program*" OR "cross-cultural teaching experience" OR "global teacher education" OR "international practicum" OR "teacher mobility") AND ("profession*" OR "competen*" OR "learning" OR "identit*" OR "development" OR "growth") AND (English OR German OR Italian)

---> **RESULT:** 49 studies (05.02.2025)

FIS Bildung

Lehramtsstudent, Lehramtsstudium, Lehramtsstudentin, Lehramtsanwärter, Referendar, Referendarin

UND

Auslandspraktikum Auslandsaufenthalt Auslandstätigkeit Auslandsstudium

UND

Professionalisierung Entwicklung Lernen Identität

UND

2000 bis 2025

---> **RESULT:** 31 studies (05.02.2025)

4.4. Study Screening and Selection

Titles and abstracts will be screened for relevance, followed by full-text reviews. The screening and selection process will be conducted by the author alone, as no second reviewer with the necessary thematic expertise and availability was accessible. This decision was made for pragmatic research reasons. To enhance reliability and minimize bias, artificial intelligence tools (u:AI, Le Chat Pro, and ChatGPT 4.0) will be used to reflect on and cross-check decisions during the process.

4.5. Data Extraction

A standardized form will be used to extract:

- General Information: Author(s), Title, Year, Language, Journal/Source, Country of Study, Country of outgoing pre-service teacher investigated
- Study Characteristics: Study Design (Qualitative, Quantitative, Mixed Methods), Research Question(s), Data Collection Methods, Analysis Methods, Data collection BEFORE internship, Data collection DURING internship, Data collection AFTER internship, Internship abroad vs. internship at home compared?
- Population: Teacher Training Focus (Educational Level), Subjects, Sample size, Characteristics of participants (e.g., age, gender, etc.), Programme type (e.g., ERASMUS+, etc.), Duration of internship/abroad experience, Geographical location and cultural context of the internship, School or Teaching Setting of Internship, Support structures provided during the stay (e.g., mentoring, supervision)
- Concept: Mention of Linguistic Diversity (Theoretical/Contextual) as relevant for teaching?, Mention of Cultural Diversity (Theoretical/Contextual) as relevant for teaching?, Both mentioned?, Neither mentioned?, Professionalization for LINGUISTIC diversity (e.g., skills, knowledge, attitudes) explicitly in focus?, Professionalization for CULTURAL diversity (e.g., skills, knowledge, attitudes) explicitly in focus?, Both explicitly in focus?, Neither in focus?, Theoretical frame for language, linguistic diversity, or multilingualism, Theoretical frame for culture, cultural diversity, or multiculturalism, Professional learning theory
- Results: Teaching in LINGUISTIC DIVERSITY: What Knowledge Development is reported?, Teaching in LINGUISTIC DIVERSITY: What Skills Development is reported?, Teaching in LINGUISTIC DIVERSITY: What Attitudinal Changes are reported?, ?, ANY results on Teaching in Linguistic Diversity reported?, Teaching in CULTURAL DIVERSITY: What Knowledge Development is reported?, Teaching in CULTURAL DIVERSITY: What Skills Development is reported?, Teaching in CULTURAL DIVERSITY: What Attitudinal Changes are reported, ANY results on Teaching in Cultural Diversity reported?, Both reported?, Neither reported?, What IMPACT on Instructional Practices is reported (if explicitly referred to as such) –

LANGUAGE?, What IMPACT on Instructional Practices is reported (if explicitly referred to as such) – CULTURE?

- Discussion: Key findings, Practical Implications: Recommendations for improving teaching internships abroad

4.6. Data Analysis and Synthesis

Descriptive statistics and narrative synthesis will be employed to analyze the extracted data.

Key themes will be charted and categorized to identify recurring patterns, thematic trends, and gaps in the literature.

The analysis will involve both deductive categorization into predefined dimensions (e.g., knowledge, attitudes, and skills) and inductive thematic coding to identify additional insights. While the analysis will be conducted primarily by the author, artificial intelligence tools (e.g., u:AI and ChatGPT 4.0) will be used to reflect on and refine categorizations and thematic coding. This approach aims to enhance reliability and compensate for the absence of a second reviewer.

Findings will be synthesized to provide a comprehensive overview of the research landscape and to highlight areas requiring further investigation.

Weger, Denis, 2025, "Pre-service Teachers' Professional Development for Cultural and/or Linguistic Diversity through Teaching Abroad: A Systematic Scoping Review (OA edition)", https://doi.org/10.11587/PCNMWP, AUSSDA.